experience were considered to ensure comparability and relevance. These programmes are designed for leadership and strategic decision-making roles and are primarily offered through blended or online modes. Most programmes run for 10–12 months, except ISB's Global Advanced Management Programme, which has a five-month duration.

The ranking considered key parameters including programme fees, duration, delivery mode, faculty quality, institutional reputation, eligibility, course sustainability, and alumni profile.



SEPARATE ZONAL RANKINGS, PARAMETER-WISE RANKINGS, AND ROI-BASED RANKINGS WERE DERIVED FROM THE MAIN RANKINGS

• **Online MBAs:** The ranking was based on secondary research data. Only two-year online or blended programs offered by recognised business schools that lead to a recognised Master's or Post-Graduate Degree/Diploma have been considered. Institutions may label these programmes as Executive MBA, Online MBA or Online PGDM, but they share a common objective: enabling professionals to earn an MBA-equivalent qualification while continuing their careers. Unlike Advanced Management Programmes, these courses cater to a broader audience with varying work-experience requirements.

The ranking was based on key parameters including programme fees, campus immersion, degree recognition, eligibility, faculty quality, institutional reputation, class frequency and duration, course sustainability, alumni network, placement outcomes and delivery mode.

• **Executive Fellow Programs in Management (EFPMs):** The ranking of EFPMs was based on objective, verified secondary data. The evaluation considered programme fees, PhD recognition, entrance requirements, work experience, institutional reputation, alumni network, faculty quality, research output, research and consultancy projects, and funding over the past three years.

These programmes generally require a master's degree or equivalent qualification with relevant work experience, and are offered under varied nomenclatures, including Executive EFPM, Executive Doctoral Programme and PhD in Management for Working Professionals. These are treated as equivalent doctoral-level programmes. Typically spanning three to six years, they are offered in online or blended modes to accommodate working professionals.

• **FPMs/PhD in management:** The FPM/PhD ranking was developed entirely through secondary research using credible public sources, including institute websites, admission brochures, annual reports and official notifications.

The programmes were evaluated across academic, financial and research parameters, including programme fees, eligibility and minimum qualifying scores, entrance exams, monthly stipend (Slabs I–III), HRA, computer and contingency allowances, conference support, PhD scholars enrolled and graduated, sponsored and consultancy projects and funding, and faculty strength.

The *BT*-MDRA B-school Ranking of 2025 was also incorporated to reflect institutional reputation and ecosystem quality. All indicators were normalised and weighted.

• **Global B-school listing:** The Global B-School listing was developed using a data-driven methodology combining international accreditations and multi-year global rankings. From over 13,000 business schools worldwide, MDRA shortlisted institutions holding at least one of the three leading international accreditations—AMBA, AACSB or EQUIS. Their performance was then mapped across Financial Times, QS Global, Times Higher Education (THE), and LinkedIn rankings for 2024–2026. To balance recency with consistency, the latest three years' rankings were weighted 50% for 2026, 30% for 2025, and 20% for 2024, while international accreditations received equal weight.

MDRA did not assign individual ranks to these institutions. The listing is intended to provide readers with a credible, broader and more insightful reference to leading global MBA options, eliminating the need to navigate thousands of business schools worldwide. Readers are advised to conduct their own research before making application or admission decisions. BT